

RECAP PHP

- Comments - single line, multiple line
- case sensitivity
- variables, scope
- Loops – while, do while, for, foreach
- Arrays types, array(), array length
- MySQLi, PDO





GET/ POST METHODS

SERVER-SIDE WEB DEVELOPMENT - **5COSC012C.2**

INTENDED LESSON OUTCOME

- At the end of the lesson students will be able to
 - Recap on HTML, CSS and SQL
 - Use PHP as a server-side scripting language;
 - For passing values for GET/ POST Methods

TODAY'S TOPICS

- Recap on HTML, CSS and SQL
- Pass values using GET/POST methods in PHP

PHP - A SIMPLE HTML FORM

```
<html>
```

```
<body>
```

```
<form action="welcome.php" method="post">
```

```
Name: <input type="text" name="name"><br>
```

```
E-mail: <input type="text" name="email"><br>
```

```
<input type="submit">
```

```
</form>
```

```
</body>
```

```
</html>
```

Result:

Name:

E-mail:

RESULTS OF FORM

//welcome.php

```
<html>
```

```
<body>
```

```
Welcome <?php echo $_POST["name"]; ?><br>
```

```
Your email address is: <?php echo
```

```
$_POST["email"]; ?>
```

```
</body>
```

```
</html>
```

BRAIN-BREAK

- **Specialty of super global variables?**
- **What are Super global variables in PHP?**



PHP GLOBAL VARIABLES - SUPERGLOBALS

Several predefined variables in PHP are "superglobals"

- which means that they are **always accessible**
- **regardless of scope**
- you can access them from any function, class or file without having to do anything special.

The PHP superglobal variables are:

- \$GLOBALS
- \$_SERVER
- \$_REQUEST
- **\$_POST**
- **\$_GET**
- \$_FILES
- \$_ENV
- \$_COOKIE
- \$_SESSION

PHP GLOBAL VARIABLES - SUPERGLOBALS

■ PHP **\$GLOBALS**

- PHP stores all global variables in an array called `$GLOBALS[index]`. The *index* holds the name of the variable

```
<?php
```

```
$x = 75;
```

```
$y = 25;
```

```
function addition() {
```

```
    $GLOBALS['z'] = $GLOBALS['x'] + $GLOBALS['y'];
```

```
}
```

```
addition();
```

```
echo $z;
```

```
?>
```

PHP GLOBAL VARIABLES - SUPERGLOBALS

PHP **\$_POST**

- PHP **\$_POST** is widely used to collect form data after submitting an HTML form with method="post".
- **\$_POST** is also widely used to pass variables

\$_POST EXAMPLE

```
<form method="post" action="<?php echo  
$_SERVER['PHP_SELF'];?>">  
    Name: <input type="text" name="fname">  
    <input type="submit">  
</form>
```

Result:

Name:

```
<?php  
if ($_SERVER["REQUEST_METHOD"] == "POST") {  
    // collect value of input field  
    $name = $_POST['fname'];  
    if (empty($name)) {  
        echo "Name is empty";  
    } else {  
        echo $name;  
    }  
}  
?>
```

Result:

Name:
sam

PHP GLOBAL VARIABLES - SUPERGLOBALS

PHP `$_GET`

- PHP `$_GET` can also be used to collect form data after submitting an HTML form with `method="get"`.
- `$_GET` can also collect data sent in the URL.

PHP \$_GET EXAMPLE

- Assume we have an HTML page that contains a hyperlink with parameters:

```
<html>
```

```
<body>
```

```
<a
```

```
href="test_get.php?subject=PHP&web=W3schools.  
com">Test $GET</a>
```

```
</body>
```

```
</html>
```

PHP \$_GET EXAMPLE CONTINUED

The example below shows the code in "test_get.php":

```
<html>
```

```
<body>
```

```
<?php
```

```
echo "Study " . $_GET['subject'] . " at " .
```

```
$_GET['web'] ;
```

```
?>
```

```
</body>
```

```
</html>
```

BRAIN-BREAK

- **Compare/Contrast
GET vs. POST**



GET VS. POST

- Both GET and POST create an array (e.g. array(key => value, key2 => value2, key3 => value3, ...)). This array holds key/value pairs, where keys are the names of the form controls and values are the input data from the user.
- Both GET and POST are treated as `$_GET` and `$_POST`. These are superglobals, which means that they are always accessible, regardless of scope - and you can access them from any function, class or file without having to do anything special.
- `$_GET` is an array of variables passed to the current script via the URL parameters.
- `$_POST` is an array of variables passed to the current script via the HTTP POST method.

WHEN TO USE GET?

- Information sent from a form with the GET method is **visible to everyone** (all variable names and values are displayed in the URL). GET also has **limits on the amount of information** to send. The limitation is about **2000 characters**. However, because the variables are displayed in the URL, it is **possible to bookmark the page**. This can be useful in some cases.
- GET may be used for sending non-sensitive data.
- **Note:** GET should NEVER be used for sending passwords or other sensitive information!

WHEN TO USE POST?

- Information sent from a form with the POST method is **invisible to others** (all names/values are embedded within the body of the HTTP request) and has **no limits** on the amount of information to send.
- Moreover POST supports advanced functionality such as support for **multi-part binary input** while uploading files to server.
- However, because the variables are not displayed in the URL, it is **not possible to bookmark the page**.

SUMMARY

- HTML, CSS and SQL Recap
- PHP GET/POST methods

NEXT LESSON

- Sessions